

Impact High · Difficulty Easy-Medium · Misuse risk Medium

THE MOVE

Decline to decide now -> Specific return time -> Honour the commitment

START HERE

When you cannot answer properly on the spot, say: 'I cannot give you the right answer now — I can have it for you by [specific time].' Then keep that commitment.

SAY THIS

Deferment Phrases	<i>"I cannot answer that properly right now. I can get back to you by end of day."</i>
Acknowledge Urgency	<i>"I understand you need this quickly — my fastest honest answer is by X."</i>
Professional Deferrals	<i>"That is a fair question — I want to check the numbers before I answer it. I will confirm by tomorrow's stand-up."</i>
Personal Deferrals	<i>"I care about getting this right more than getting it fast — can we talk tomorrow evening?"</i>
Deferring Under Pressure	<i>"I understand the pressure to decide now. A rushed answer would cost us more than a day's wait."</i>

AVOID

- When you know the answer already — deferring when you could decide now signals avoidance.
- When the other person needs an answer urgently and deferment will cause real harm or delay.
- When the pattern of deferring to this person is already eroding their trust in your reliability.

REMEMBER

The specific time is the whole technique.